YOGA

IDENTITY AND DEFINITION → SOURCE CONTROL → MIND-FIELD → REFLECTION AND EGOITY → FIVE LEVELS → FIVE MODIFICATIONS → WHY RESTRAINT → PRACTICE AND DISPASSION → TRANSFORMATION → AFFLICTIONS → ENGINE OF BONDAGE → EIGHT LIMBS → TWO ABSORPTION GRIDS → RESIDUE AND SEEDLESSNESS → INSIGHT AND POWERS → THE LORD → ISOLATION → REALISM, VERDICT AND ANSWER ROUTE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis at Stage 17. Each card uses the internal structure its content demands; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • repaired Topic 06 package; all prior artifacts unchanged

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 IDENTITY, DEFINITION AND THE SĀṂKHYA INHERITANCE

YOGA = RESTRAINT OF MENTAL MODIFICATION · A STATE, NOT AN ACTIVITY · SEŚVARA-SĀṂKHYA — THEISTIC SĀṂKHYA · SĀṂKHYA-PRAVACANA — SĀṂKHYA-EXPOSITION · ONTOLOGY INHERITED · METHOD OWNED · PURUṢA-VIŚEṢA — A SPECIAL WITNESS

PATAÑJALI'S YOGA-SŪTRA — FOUR CHAPTERS (PĀDA)

SAMĀDHI-PĀDA — definition · five modifications · practice and dispassion · the Lord · seedless absorption → SĀDHANA-PĀDA — preparatory discipline · five afflictions · action and fruition · the eight limbs → VIBHŪTI-PĀDA — combined discipline · three transformations · extraordinary capacities and their demotion

THE DEFINING APHORISMS

- **YS 1.2** yogaś-citta-vṛtti-nirodhaḥ — Yoga is the restraint of the modifications of the mind-field.
- **YS 1.3** tadā draṣṭuḥ svarūpe'vasthānam — then the seer abides in its own nature.
- **YS 1.4** otherwise the seer takes the FORM of the modifications. That is what bondage IS.

INHERITED FROM SĀṂKHYA — RESTATED, NOT RE-ARGUED

- Many conscious witnesses (puruṣa); one primordial material nature (prakṛti).
- Three constituent qualities (guṇa); twenty-five principles (tattva).
- Effect pre-exists in the cause (satkāryavāda); real transformation (pariṇāmavāda).
- Bondage is non-discrimination; release is discriminative knowledge.

OWNED BY YOGA — THE ANSWERABLE SYLLABUS ITEM

- Mind-field psychology, five modifications, the afflicted/unafflicted division.
- Practice and dispassion; five afflictions; moral causation of action; the eight limbs.
- Absorption taxonomies, combined discipline, the Lord, discriminative discernment.
- Cloud-of-dharma absorption and isolation. **Syllabus item 17: Yoga; Citta; Cittavṛtti; Klesas; Samadhi; Kaivalya.**

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Sāṃkhya supplies the metaphysical map and Yoga supplies the training that makes a traveller able to read it.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Yoga does not add a new world to Sāṃkhya's world; it adds a discipline to Sāṃkhya's argument, which is why its definition is a psychological state and not a metaphysical thesis.

01

STAGE 01 SOURCE CONTROL — WHICH LAYER IS SPEAKING

SŪTRA VERSUS COMMENTARY · VYĀSA — YOGA-BHĀṢYA · VĀCASPATI MIŚRA — TATTVAVAIŚĀRADĪ · VIJÑĀNABHIKṢU — YOGAVĀRTTIKA · DATING AND LAYERING ARE DISPUTED · IDENTIFY THE SYSTEM; NEVER DATE IT

ITEM	TRUE ATTRIBUTION	WHAT IT LICENSES
Definition of Yoga	Patañjali, YS 1.2-1.4	Quote directly; it is the answer's first sentence
Five mind-levels	Vyāsa-onward commentarial exposition	Use for the 2019 question, attributed to the commentary
Four stages of lower dispassion	Commentarial elaboration	Cite as refinement; YS 1.15 is Patañjali's own definition
Grounds for the Lord	YS 1.24-1.28 are compact and practice-facing	Do not project later creator-proofs backward

THE RULE OF USE

- The aphorisms are headings; the commentary supplies the paragraphs. Use the whole tradition, but name the layer.
- Commentarial standing is not a defect — it is a fact about attribution that source-sensitive questions test.

WHAT MUST NOT BE PROMOTED INTO THE SŪTRA TEXT

- The five mind-levels (citta-bhūmi) — standard from Vyāsa onward, **not** a five-item aphorism.
- The four stages of lower dispassion — yatamāna, vyatireka, ekendriya, vaśīkāra.
- The expanded theoretical proof-set for the Lord, drawn from scripture and maximal degrees.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Source control is not scepticism but labelling, and the examiner rewards a candidate who can use the whole tradition and still say which part of it is speaking.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Yoga-sūtra is a text of headings and the tradition that reads it is a text of paragraphs; a Yoga answer earns its authority by never confusing the two.

02

STAGE 02 THE MIND-FIELD — CONSTITUTION AND DERIVATION

CITTA = BUDDHI + AHAṂKĀRA + MANAS · JAḌA — INSENTIENT IN ITSELF · SATTVA-PREDOMINANT AS A WHOLE · TRANSPARENT, THEREFORE REFLECTIVE · NOT NYĀYA'S ATOMIC MANAS · THE PSYCHICAL INSTRUMENT, NOT THE SELF

PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (prakṛti)

DETERMINATIVE INTELLECT (buddhi / mahat) evolves first → EGO-MAKER (ahaṃkāra) evolves from intellect → SENSORY MIND (manas) evolves from the ego-maker's lucid side

THREE FUNCTIONS, ONE APPARATUS

- **buddhi** — determinative intellect: ascertainment, decision, discrimination and resolve.
- **ahaṃkāra** — ego-maker: appropriation as 'I', ownership of states, doership.
- **manas** — sensory mind: co-ordination of sense-data, doubt and oscillation.
- Sāṃkhya separates them analytically; Yoga treats them as one operative continuum because bondage is suffered by the whole interior.

THE PRECISION POINT THAT DECIDES CLOSE OPTIONS

- Only **manas** derives directly from the lucid side of the ego-maker.
- Sattva-predominance is a property of the working whole; it is not a derivation of intellect and ego from lucid ego-maker.

CONTRASTS THAT MUST BE HELD

- **Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika** — atomic, partless internal sense plus a separate self-substance.
- **Advaita** — inner instrument under beginningless ignorance inside a Brahman framework; Yoga has no Brahman doctrine.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because bondage runs through the mind-field, release must also be worked there: the witness is eternally unmodifiable and offers no surface for work.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Gathering intellect, ego-maker and sense-mind under a single name is not terminological convenience but a claim that bondage is suffered by the whole interior and therefore cannot be cured faculty by faculty.

03

STAGE 03 REFLECTION, MERE PROXIMITY AND THE BIRTH OF EGOITY

PRATIBIMBA — REFLECTION · SANNIDHI-MĀTRA — MERE PROXIMITY · UPARĀGA — COLOURED BY THE OBJECT · ASMITĀ — EGOITY · SVA-SVĀMI-ŚAKTI CONFUSION · APARIṆĀMIN — THE WITNESS NEVER CHANGES

THE DOUBLE BORROWING

- The mind takes the **colour of objects** — that is cognition (uparāga).
- The mind takes the **light of the witness** — that is the feeling of being someone (pratibimba / chāyā).
- Bondage is the second borrowing misread: borrowed light read as owned light, and witnesshood read as agency.
- **Images:** a clear crystal (sphaṭika) beside a red flower; a magnet moving iron by mere presence.

OBJECTION

- Reflection normally presupposes a real relation between mirror and original.
- If witness and nature are ontologically disjoint, how can an inactive witness be reflected at all?

REPLY AND RESIDUAL FORCE

- **Reply:** the transformation is entirely on the mind's side; the witness neither acts nor changes.
- **Residue:** mere proximity names the relation more clearly than it explains it. Advaita presses by collapsing the duality; Nyāya by making consciousness an adventitious property of a substantial self.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — This is the 2024 question in doctrinal form: so long as the mind changes, the self is reflected there and, lacking discriminative knowledge, identifies with the changes.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Yoga's reflection theory is designed to let bondage be devastating and unreal at once: devastating in experience, because the misreading governs a whole life, and unreal in metaphysics, because nothing has happened to the one who seems bound.

04

STAGE 04 THE FIVE LEVELS OF THE MIND-FIELD AND THE 2019 APPLICATION

KṢIPTA · MŪḌHA · VIKṢIPTA · EKĀGRA · NIRUDDHA · CLASSIFIED BY RULING QUALITY · ONLY THE LAST TWO ARE YOGA-FIT · SCIENTIST = VIKṢIPTA · DEVOTEE = EKĀGRA · YOGIN = NIRUDDHA · COMMENTARIAL, NOT A SŪTRA LIST

LEVEL	RULING QUALITY	CHARACTER	FIT?
kṣipta (scattered)	rajas, active	runs object to object; activity without integration	No
mūḍha (dull)	tamas, inert	torpor and delusion: obscuration, not calm	No
vikṣipta (distracted)	mixed, occasional sattva	attends and analyses but cannot stay collected	Partly
ekāgra (one-pointed)	sattva, lucid	sustained one-pointedness on a chosen support	Yes
niruddha (restrained)	modifications arrested	consummation of disciplined inwardness	Yes

THE DECISIVE TRANSITION

- From **vikṣipta** to **ekāgra**: occasional concentration becomes sustained one-pointedness.
- The criterion is the ruling quality and the stability of inward collection — never the force of attention.

THE 2019 JUSTIFICATION THAT CARRIES THE MARKS

- A scientist is intensely focused but outward-directed, result-attached and interrupted, so the ruling quality is still rajas.
- A God-realised devotee is lucid-dominant on a single support; dedication to the Lord stabilises the field and removes obstacles.
- A self-realised practitioner has all modifications stilled — the culmination, not blank unconsciousness.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The scheme is Yoga's quiet refusal to flatter intelligence, because it grades minds by which quality rules them rather than by cognitive power.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: On Yoga's grading a distracted genius sits below a one-pointed devotee, because high intellectual focus does not itself amount to yogic restraint.

05

STAGE 05 THE FIVE MODIFICATIONS AND THE AFFLICTED CUT

PRAMĀṆA · VIPARYAYA · VIKALPA · NIDRĀ · SMṚTI · KLIṢṬA VERSUS AKLIṢṬA · EVEN TRUE COGNITION IS A MODIFICATION · SLEEP IS A POSITIVE MODE · THE DIVISION NEVER QUALIFIES AFFLICTIONS · WHAT BINDS IS FORM, NOT FALSITY

MODIFICATION	DEFINITION	WORKED EXAMPLE
pramāṇa (valid cognition)	perception, inference, authoritative testimony	smoke seen, fire correctly inferred
viparyaya (error)	false cognition not matching the object	nacre taken for silver
vikalpa (verbal construction)	cognition from words alone with no referent	'the horn of a hare'
nidrā (sleep)	a positive mode grounded on absence-content	'I slept and knew nothing'
smṛti (memory)	non-loss and re-presentation of experience	recollection of past pain

THE LADDER RULE

- Unafflicted modifications cancel afflicted ones and then themselves subside.
- Yoga does not abolish cognition at once; it first transforms the quality of mental life and only then lets even the therapeutic forms cease.

TRAPS THAT COST MARKS

- The kliṣṭa/akliṣṭa division qualifies **modifications** only; afflictions are inherently afflictive.
- Sleep is one of the five modifications, not the absence of modification, and quiescence is therefore not liberation.
- Yoga accepts three instruments of valid knowledge; it does not reject valid cognition.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Classifying mental life by form rather than by truth or moral value is what turns Yoga's psychology into a soteriology.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Yoga's most counter-intuitive move is to place true knowledge on the list of things that must eventually stop, and it is defensible because what binds the seer is not the falsity of a mental form but the fact that it is a form at all.

06

STAGE 06 WHY RESTRAINT IS PRESCRIBED — THE FIVE-STEP DERIVATION

FORM-TAKING → REFLECTION → APPROPRIATION · MODIFICATIONS ARE MECHANISM, NOT SYMPTOM · NIRODHA IS REVELATORY, NOT DESTRUCTIVE · THREE INSTRUMENTS ONLY · YOGI-PRATYAKṢA IS NOT A FOURTH PRAMĀṆA · THE SETTLED POOL REFLECTS ONE SKY

STEP 1 — the mind-field takes the FORM of whatever it attends to → STEP 2 — the witness's consciousness is REFLECTED in that form → STEP 3 — in ignorance the form is APPROPRIATED: 'I know', 'I suffer', 'I desire', 'I remember' → STEP 4 — therefore the stream of modifications SUSTAINS bondage; it is the running mechanism → STEP 5 — therefore restraint UNCOVERS the already-free seer

THE EPISTEMOLOGY THAT LIMITS THE CLAIM

- Yoga admits **three** instruments: perception (pratyakṣa), inference (anumāna), authoritative testimony (āgama/śabda).
- Counts to keep apart: Yoga 3 · Sāṃkhya 3 · Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika 4 · Buddhist epistemologists 2 · Advaita commonly 6.
- Perfected meditative insight is classified as extraordinary yogic perception, not as a new means of knowledge — and it remains a modification.

WHAT RESTRAINT DOES NOT MEAN

- It is not the destruction of the mind as a substance, and not the extinction of awareness.
- It removes concealment, not consciousness: the seer was already free, and restraint uncovers that.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A mechanism can be interrupted whereas a symptom can only be masked, which is why the fourth step is the load-bearing move of the whole argument.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Yoga prescribes cessation not because thought is bad but because thought is the running machinery of a mistake: as long as the mind keeps producing forms, the seer keeps being handed something to be.

07

STAGE 07 PRACTICE AND DISPASSION — THE TWO HANDLES

ABHYĀSA — SUSTAINED PRACTICE · VAIRĀGYA — DISPASSION · JOINTLY RESPONSIBLE, YS 1.12 · LONG · UNINTERRUPTED · DEVOTED · APARA-VAIRĀGYA INCLUDES HEAVENLY REWARD · PARA-VAIRĀGYA RELEASES EVEN THE GUṆAS

PRACTICE — WHAT MAKES IT FIRM

- Effort to remain stable in restraint, firmly grounded only when cultivated for a **long time**, **without interruption** and **with devoted seriousness**.
- Its function is continuity against old impressions (saṃskāra), which would otherwise return the mind to habitual forms.

DISPASSION — TWO GRADES

- **Lower (YS 1.15)** — mastery over thirst for objects seen **and** objects promised by scripture; no subtler acquisitiveness is licensed.
- **Higher (YS 1.16)** — non-thirst even for the constituent qualities, following knowledge of the witness; it releases attachment to subtle states, insight and powers.
- Commentarial ladder inside the lower grade: yatamāna, vyatireka, ekendriya, vaśīkāra.

THE TWO FAILURE MODES

- Practice without dispassion becomes strain and relapse — a permanent tug-of-war against undiminished desire.
- Dispassion without practice becomes a mood without capacity.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Practice answers the problem of continuity while dispassion answers the problem of direction, which is why the higher grade is generated by discernment rather than by more effort.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Yoga's method is deliberately two-handed: practice supplies the continuity that old impressions would otherwise win, and dispassion removes the fuel that would otherwise make the contest permanent.

08

STAGE 08 REAL TRANSFORMATION OF THE MIND-SUBSTRATE

CITTA-PARIṆĀMA — REAL CHANGE · DHARMIN — A PERSISTING SUBSTRATE · DHARMA · LAKṢAṆA · AVASTHĀ · AGAINST KṢAṆIKAVĀDA · AGAINST VIVARTAVĀDA · THE SUBSTRATE IS NATURE, NOT A SELF

NIRODHA-PARIṆĀMA — impressions of restraint overpower impressions of emergence → SAMĀDHI-PARIṆĀMA — many-pointedness declines as one object becomes dominant → EKĀGRATĀ-PARIṆĀMA — similar cognitions succeed one another toward the same object

WHY A BEARER IS NEEDED

- Practice accumulates; impressions are deposited and retrieved; a practitioner acquires a stable capacity.
- None of these is a feature of a mere succession, so a graded path presupposes something that carries what it has undergone.
- General frame: any substrate of nature changes in **property**, **temporal phase** and **condition** without ceasing to be that substrate.

THE CONTESTED JOINT

- **Buddhist momentarist:** a stream of momentary events suffices; the substrate is an idle postulate.
- **Residual force:** a sufficiently rich causal series may reproduce much of what Yoga assigns to a substrate.
- **Advaita:** change is only apparent — Yoga insists the change in mind and nature is real.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — One lake can be stormy, then calming, then still: three genuinely different states and one lake throughout.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Yoga needs a mind that both changes and lasts, because a path promising graded progress can be built neither on something that never really changes nor on something that never lasts long enough to have progressed.

09

STAGE 09 THE FIVE AFFLICTIONS AND THEIR FOUR STATES

AVIDYĀ IS THE ROOT, NOT ITEM ONE · FOUR REVERSALS DEFINE IGNORANCE · ASMITĀ · RĀGA · DVEṢA · ABHINIVEŚA · PRESENT EVEN IN THE LEARNED · PRASUPTA · TANU · VICCHINNA · UDĀRA · DORMANCY IS NOT DESTRUCTION

IGNORANCE (avidyā) — the field in which the rest grow

EGOITY (asmitā) — the seer confused with the instrument of seeing → ATTACHMENT (rāga) and AVERSION (dveṣa) — memory-driven pursuit and flight → CLINGING TO LIFE (abhiniveśa) — instinctive, and it survives learning

IGNORANCE — THE FOUR REVERSALS

- The **non-eternal** taken as eternal; the **impure** taken as pure.
- The **painful** taken as pleasant; the **non-self** taken as self.
- This is not a gap in information but a standing misorientation that structures a whole life.

THE FOUR DERIVATIVES

- **asmitā** — the seer identified with the instrument of seeing: 'I think, I act, I suffer'.
- **rāga** and **dveṣa** — pursuit following remembered pleasure and flight following remembered pain.
- **abhiniveśa** — instinctive clinging to life, carried by impressions rather than by opinions, and therefore present even in the learned.

THE FOUR STATES AND THE DIAGNOSTIC RULE

- **prasupta** dormant · **tanu** attenuated · **vicchinna** interrupted · **udāra** fully active.
- 'I no longer feel it' is compatible with dormancy, attenuation **and** interruption; only destruction of the seed removes an affliction.
- Therapy ladder: gross expression by discipline, subtle form by meditation, the seed by discriminative discernment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the four derivatives grow within the field of ignorance, no derivative can be removed durably while the root stands.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Yoga's list of afflictions ends with the fear of death and insists that it survives learning, a deliberate admission that the disease it treats is deeper than opinion and therefore not curable by instruction.

10

STAGE 10 THE ENGINE OF BONDAGE AND ITS FIRST THERAPY

KARMĀŚAYA — KLEŚA-MŪLA · VIPĀKA IS THREEFOLD · JĀTI · ĀYUS · BHOGA · SAṂSKĀRA AND VĀSANĀ CARRY IT · KRIYĀ-YOGA THINS THE AFFLICTIONS · DAGDHA-BĪJA — THE BURNT SEED

AFFLICTIONS (kleśa) motivate action → ACTION (karma) deposits the karmic store (karmāśaya), rooted in the afflictions → FRUITION (vipāka) ripens as birth (jāti), life-span (āyus) and experience (bhoga) → EXPERIENCE generates fresh reaction and the loop closes in renewed birth (punarjanma)

PREPARATORY DISCIPLINE — THE STATED PURPOSE

- **tapas** — disciplined, heat-generating effort.
- **svādhyāya** — study and recitation of sacred teaching with reflective self-examination.
- **Īśvara-praṇidhāna** — surrender of the fruits and of the ego's proprietary claim; also a niyama and an independent means to absorption.
- Its explicit purpose is to **attenuate the afflictions** and prepare absorption.

FOUR COLOURS OF ACTION

- **śukla** white · **kṛṣṇa** black · **śukla-kṛṣṇa** mixed — the ordinary human mixture.
- **aśukla-akṛṣṇa** neither white nor black — the practitioner whose action no longer produces ordinary bondage.

THE SCALE OBJECTION AND ITS REPLY

- **Objection:** if release requires exhausting an unsurveyable stock of deposit, release is indefinitely postponed.
- **Reply:** liberating knowledge burns the seeds of future bondage; a burnt seed keeps its shape and cannot germinate.
- **Qualification:** the potter's wheel turns after the push stops — residual embodiment without fresh bondage.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the first link of the chain is psychological, disciplined work on attention, habit and motive is causally interruptive rather than merely palliative.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Yoga earns the right to call itself a path to liberation at exactly one point: it shows that the machinery of rebirth has a psychological first link, and a first link is a place where a machine can be stopped.

11

STAGE 11 THE EIGHT-LIMBED DISCIPLINE AND COMBINED DISCIPLINE

BAHIRAṄGA — FIVE EXTERNAL LIMBS · ANTARAṄGA — THREE INTERNAL LIMBS · SAṂYAMA = LIMBS 6 + 7 + 8 ON ONE OBJECT · SĀRVABHAUMA-MAHĀVRATA, YS 2.31 · NINE ANTARĀYAS AND FOUR SYMPTOMS · ETHICS IS PART OF THE TECHNIQUE

YAMA and NIYAMA — social-ethical purification and positive self-cultivation → ĀSANA and PRĀṆĀYĀMA — a steady seat and the regulation of breath calm embodiment → PRATYĀHĀRA — withdrawal releases the senses from compulsive extroversion → DHĀRAṆĀ, DHYĀNA, SAMĀDHI — concentration, sustained flow and consummated absorption

THE FIVE RESTRAINTS AND FIVE OBSERVANCES

- **yama** — ahiṃsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya, aparigraha; unrestricted by birth, place, time or circumstance they form the universal great vow.
- **niyama** — śauca, santoṣa, tapas, svādhyāya, Īśvara-praṇidhāna; the last three overlap with preparatory discipline.

THE INTERNAL THREE ARE GRADED, NOT SYNONYMOUS

- **dhāraṇā** binds the mind to one locus — effortful fixing and the first clear sign of one-pointedness.
- **dhyāna** is uninterrupted flow toward that same object, and it burns subtle afflictions.
- **samādhi** is the state in which the object alone shines and discursiveness recedes.

OBSTACLES AND REMEDIES

- **Nine obstacles:** disease, mental stagnation, doubt, carelessness, laziness, sensual non-restraint, false vision, failure to attain a stage, instability in an attained stage.
- **Four symptoms:** suffering, dejection, bodily tremor, disturbed inhalation and exhalation.
- **Remedies:** dedication to the Lord; practice of one principle; friendliness, compassion, gladness and equanimity; breath regulation; suitable supports.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — 'External' means preparatory with respect to subtler operations, not unimportant, which is why Yoga answers no to the question whether meditation suffices without ethics.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Yoga begins its technical programme with how one treats other beings, and that ordering is a philosophical claim: a mind at war with its own conduct cannot be asked to become one-pointed without being asked to fight itself.

12

STAGE 12 ABSORPTION — THE TWO GRIDS THAT MUST NOT BE CONFLATED

SAMPRAJÑĀTA = WITH SEED, YS 1.46 · YS 1.17 — VITARKA, VICĀRA, ĀNANDA, ASMITĀ · YS 1.42-1.44 — SAMĀPATTI-BHEDAS · ŚABDA-ARTHA-JÑĀNA-VIKALPA · COMMENTATORS MAP, THEY DO NOT IDENTIFY · ALIṄGA — THE UNDIFFERENTIATED LIMIT

COALESCENCE	OBJECT-RANGE	CONCEPTUAL OVERLAY
savitarkā	gross (sthūla)	mixed with word-object-knowledge construction
nirvitarkā	gross	memory and verbal construction purified
savicārā	subtle (sūkṣma)	subtle reflective consideration remains
nirvicārā	subtle	even subtle reflective overlay is stilled

GRID A — WHAT ACCOMPANIES THE ABSORPTION

- **vitarka** gross deliberative grasp · **vicāra** subtle reflection.
- **ānanda** refined lucid joy — not ordinary pleasure. **asmitā** bare I-am-ness — not the binding affliction, but an extremely subtle objectification of the I-sense.
- Joy and I-am-ness are therefore not a contested later addition; they are in the aphorism itself.

GRID B — WHAT IT RESTS ON, AND HOW CLEAN

- The **sa-/nir-** prefix marks the presence or absence of conceptual-verbal overlay.
- The **vitarka/vicāra** distinction marks gross (sthūla) versus subtle (sūkṣma) object.
- YS 1.45 extends the subtle domain up to the undifferentiated; YS 1.46 declares all of these with-seed.

THE SENTENCE THAT MUST NEVER BE WRITTEN

- 'The four types of samprajñāta listed by Patañjali are savitarka, nirvitarka, savicāra and nirvicāra.'
- It merges a factor-list with an object-list, and it is the error the 2020 and 2022 questions are best placed to expose.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — One grid asks what accompanies the absorption and the other asks what it rests on and how conceptually clean it is, so mapping them is a commentarial task rather than a textual identity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Yoga classifies absorption twice because it is answering two different questions, and the candidate who collapses the two lists has answered neither.

13

STAGE 13 BEYOND THE GRIDS — RESIDUE, SEEDLESSNESS AND THE TWO ROUTES

ASAṂPRAJÑĀTA = SAṂSKĀRA-ŚEṢA, YS 1.18 · NIRBĪJA = EVEN THAT RESIDUE RESTRAINED, YS 1.51 · TWO SENSES OF 'SEED' · BHAVA-PRATYAYA — CONDITION-BASED · UPĀYA-PRATYAYA — MEANS-BASED · NOT SLEEP: NIDRĀ IS ITSELF A VṚTTI

YS 1.47 — the clarity of nirvicārā yields inner clarity of the self-field (adhyātma-prasāda) → YS 1.48 — therein the insight is truth-bearing (ṛtambharā) → YS 1.18 — supra-cognitive absorption: preceded by the practice of cessation, having impression-residue → YS 1.51 — when that residue too is restrained, absorption is seedless (nirbīja)

THE TERMINOLOGICAL CONTROL

- **sabīja (YS 1.46)** = with object-support. **nirbīja (YS 1.51)** = without the residual impression.
- Losing the object-support does not by itself make an absorption seedless.
- Safe formula: asaṃprajñāta = modifications stopped with impression-residue remaining; nirbīja = even that residue restrained.

THE TWO ROUTES — BASES, NOT A THIRD CLASS

- **YS 1.19** condition-based, associated with disembodied and nature-merged beings; commentators warn that nature-mergence need not equal final discriminative isolation.
- **YS 1.20** means-based, through faith, energy, mindfulness, absorption and wisdom — the route that better displays Yoga's soteriological method.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Even when active modifications cease, latent impressions can remain as residual potency, which is exactly why temporary calm or trance is not yet liberation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Supra-cognitive absorption is defined by what remains and seedless absorption by the restraint of exactly that remainder, so the two terms negate different things and must never be treated as synonyms.

14

STAGE 14 TRUTH-BEARING INSIGHT, POWERS AND THE CLOUD OF DHARMA

ṚTAMBHARĀ PRAJÑĀ, YS 1.48 · FIELD = VIŚEṢA-ARTHA, THE PARTICULAR · NOT A FOURTH PRAMĀṆA · SIDDHI = SAMĀDHĀV UPASARGĀḤ, YS 3.37 · DHARMAMEGHA-SAMĀDHI · PARA-VAIRĀGYA GOVERNS THE SUMMIT

TRUTH-BEARING INSIGHT — USED, THEN SURRENDERED

- Its field is a **particular** object, where testimony and inference reach universals and general relations.
- Its impression obstructs other impressions (YS 1.50) — an unafflicted modification cancelling afflicted ones.
- It is best classified as perfected extraordinary yogic perception, and it must itself cease before absorption becomes seedless.
- **Caution:** its resemblance to later conceptions of knowledge by identity is thematic only.

EXTRAORDINARY CAPACITIES — CREDITED AND DEMOTED

- Combined discipline may yield extraordinary capacities; YS 3.37 declares them attainments in the outward-turned state but **obstacles to absorption** when they attract appropriation.
- They reactivate egoity, attachment and pride, and belong to the side-effects of discipline rather than to the essence of isolation.
- Reporting them is doctrinal exposition, not empirical endorsement.

THE CULMINATION IS DEFINED BY RELINQUISHMENT

- In cloud-of-dharma absorption the cloud of dharma rains down the fullness of discriminative knowledge.
- Even fascination with extraordinary knowledge or power is relinquished; the practitioner no longer seeks omniscience, attainment or display.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each demotion follows from the school's own diagnosis, since the disease was identification with mental forms and an exalted mental form is still a mental form.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The most disciplined thing about Yoga is what it says about its own successes: its highest insight is classified as a ladder, its extraordinary powers as obstacles, and its final absorption by the surrender of interest in both.

15

STAGE 15 THE LORD — SPECIAL WITNESS, SACRED SYLLABLE, BOUNDED THEISM

PURUṢA-VIŚEṢA, YS 1.24 · UNTOUCHED BY KLEŚA-KARMA-VIPĀKA-ĀŚAYA · UNSURPASSED SEED OF OMNISCIENCE, YS 1.25 · TEACHER OF THE ANCIENTS, YS 1.26 · PRAṆAVA (OṂ), YS 1.27-1.28 · INSTRUMENTAL, NOT CONSTITUTIVE

ĪŚVARA — A SPECIAL CONSCIOUS WITNESS, NEVER ENTANGLED

DEFINITION — untouched by affliction, action, fruition and karmic deposit → PREDICATES — unsurpassed omniscience, timeless teacherhood, denoted by the sacred syllable → FUNCTION — concentration-support, obstacle-removal, exemplarity and pedagogic authority

FIVE POSITIVE ROLES

- Object of meditation — one-pointed devotion stabilises the mind-field.
- Aid through dedication — surrender reduces egoity and attachment.
- Remover of the nine obstacles; perfect model of untouched status; timeless teacher-principle anchoring transmission.

FIVE NEGATIONS

- Not the material cause — primordial nature remains that.
- Not the Nyāya creator, efficient cause and moral governor of the world-order.
- Not a devotional saviour granting liberation arbitrarily; not one of the ordinary bound witnesses; not a substitute for discriminative discernment.

OBJECTIONS AND THE EXACT REPLIES

- **From Godless Sāṃkhya:** why add a Lord if the ontology already explains liberation? **Reply:** practical efficacy — a unique focus of devotion, obstacle-removal and support for absorption.
- **From redundancy:** if discriminative discernment liberates, is he not dispensable? **Reply:** not redundant, but **non-final**.
- **Source control:** the theoretical proof-set from scripture, maximal degrees and cosmic coordination is later commentarial, not Patañjali's.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Every predicate of the Lord in the aphorisms is practice-facing rather than cosmological, which is how the school admits a real God without disturbing a dualist ontology.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Yoga's God is defined by an absence and employed for a presence: he is the one witness never entangled, and precisely that makes him the most effective object for a mind trying to disentangle itself.

16

STAGE 16 ISOLATION — THE ROAD, THE INVOLUTION AND THE FOUR NEGATIONS

KAIVALYA — ALONENESS, NOT UNION · VIVEKA-KHYĀTI IS DECISIVE · PRATIPRASAVA — INVOLUTION OF THE GUṆAS · SVARŪPA-PRATIṢṬHĀ — SELF-ABIDANCE · KṢETRIKA — THE FARMER BREACHES THE BANK · NOT BRAHMAN-IDENTITY, NOT APAVARGA

PRACTICE AND DISPASSION → preparatory discipline and the eight limbs → ATTENUATION AND DESTRUCTION of the afflictions → stable absorption → VIVEKA-KHYĀTI → PARA-VAIRĀGYA → DHARMAMEGHA-SAMĀDHI → KAIVALYA — involution of the qualities and abiding in one's own nature

FOUR NEGATIONS THAT GUARD THE TERM

- Not union with God in the devotional sense; not identity with Brahman in the Advaita sense.
- Not annihilation of consciousness; not mere painlessness abstracted from the self's own luminosity.
- And not destruction of mind as a substance — its binding modifications cease and its function is reabsorbed.

THREE IMAGES THAT DO THE WORK

- **Farmer (kṣetrika):** he breaches the embankment and water flows by its own nature — discipline removes obstruction rather than manufacturing freedom.
- **Burnt seed:** destroyed afflictions keep their shape and cannot germinate.
- **Potter's wheel:** after the push stops the wheel turns until momentum is spent — the careful basis for liberation-while-living language.

THE TWO CONTRASTS UPSC TESTS

- **Against Advaita liberation:** many witnesses versus one Brahman; disentanglement versus identity-realisation.
- **Against Nyāya release:** Nyāya emphasises the cessation of suffering, Yoga the isolation and self-abidance of the witness.
- **The Lord's role:** he assists but does not grant isolation; liberation finally follows discriminative discernment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the witness was never altered, the whole account of liberation has to be given in terms of what ceases rather than in terms of what is acquired.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Isolation is the only liberation in Indian philosophy defined by a subtraction: nothing is gained, nothing is joined, and what ends is a sentence — 'I am this' — that was never true.

17

STAGE 17 REALISM, CRITICISMS, PYQ ROUTES AND THE GRADED VERDICT

KAIVALYA-PĀDA REALISM · EKACITTA-TANTRA REFUSED · NA TAT SVĀBHĀSAM — CITTA IS DṚŚYA · SEVEN OWNED PYQS, 2019-2025 · ONE ROUTED COMPARISON, 2018 · STRONG · WEAK · CONTESTED

DEFINE in Pātañjala terms → CLASSIFY without conflating the two absorption grids → GIVE the causal pathway from affliction to bondage, and from discipline to discernment → DISTINGUISH from Sāṃkhya, Nyāya, Buddhism or Advaita exactly as the directive demands → STATE objection, reply and residual pressure → CONCLUDE with the qualified verdict

FOUR REALIST ARGUMENTS AGAINST CONSCIOUSNESS-ONLY

- **Object-independence:** an object is not dependent on a single mind, or it would vanish when unattended.
- **The mind's knownness:** citta is not self-illuminating because it is itself something seen for the witness.
- **No simultaneous self-cognition:** the mind cannot be both lamp and illuminated object in one act.
- **Colouring:** an object is known when citta is coloured by it, which implies the object is not identical with the cognition. **Counter:** shared karmic traces. **Residue:** Yoga must still say how an external object colours an insentient mind.

PYQ OWNERSHIP AND ROUTE

- **2019 Q7(b) 15** citta-levels → Stage 04. **2020 Q5(b) 10** the two absorptions → Stages 12-13.
- **2021 Q6(a) 20** afflictions to isolation → Stages 09, 10, 16. **2022 Q5(c) 10** stages of absorption and the Lord → Stages 12-15.
- **2023 Q7(c) 15** mind-field, modifications and cessation → Stages 02, 05, 06. **2024 Q7(b) 15** reflection and appraisal → Stages 03, 08, 17.
- **2025 Q7(b) 15** the nature of God and isolation → Stages 15-16. **Routed 2018 Q6(a) 20** Nyāya versus Yoga proofs → Stages 15, 17.

THE GRADED VERDICT

- **Strong:** rigorous phenomenology of mental process; integration of psychology, ethics and metaphysics; an operational path; genuine metaphysical commitment.
- **Weak:** the witness-nature interaction problem; the Lord's limited explanatory role; the contestable value of contentless pure consciousness.
- **Contested:** the commentarial status of joy and I-am-ness; whether isolation is austere or blissful; the layering of the sūtra tradition.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Yoga turns Sāṃkhya's dualism into a disciplined psychology of liberation in which ethics, attention, absorption and insight progressively dismantle the causal machinery of bondage.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Isolation rests not on trance but on irreversible discrimination between the luminous witness and every transformation of nature, which is why Yoga is philosophically richer than a praxis manual even where its dualism remains exposed.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH · IS THE LORD NECESSARY? · HOW SHARP ARE THE UPPER ABSORPTIONS? · KNOWLEDGE OR ABSORPTION? · ONE MOVE MAXIMUM IN AN ANSWER

MODULE 1 — IS THE LORD PHILOSOPHICALLY NECESSARY?

- Stronger theistic reading: the Lord is central to Yoga's identity against Godless Sāṃkhya.
- Pragmatic reading: the ontology is Sāṃkhyan and the Lord is a uniquely powerful practical aid.
- Verdict for an answer: instrumental rather than constitutive, with the necessity claim left open.

MODULE 2 — HOW SHARPLY DIVIDE THE UPPER ABSORPTIONS?

- Some readings compress supra-cognitive, seedless and cloud-of-dharma absorption into one condition variously described.
- Others keep fine distinctions; the YS 1.18 versus YS 1.51 contrast is core, not optional, and only the further relation belongs here.

MODULE 3 — WHAT LIBERATES: ABSORPTION OR KNOWLEDGE?

- Absorption-heavy reading treats meditative cessation as decisive; cognition-heavy reading makes absorption serve discriminative discernment.
- Yoga's reply is that its psychology explains how such knowledge is stabilised and made existentially efficacious.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This block is unnecessary for a competent core answer and belongs only in the evaluative paragraph of a fifteen- or twenty-mark response.